IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 4

Travel and Holidays

Holidays, experiences and giving reasons

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 4 · Book pp. 47–57

LEARNING GOAL

Talk and write about holidays and travel experiences, with reasons

Objectives: you will…

- name types of holiday and holiday activities
- read several texts for specific information
- listen for specific information and detail
- add detail and reasons when you speak
- use the past simple and present simple
- write an email and talk about experiences

Success criteria: I can…

- use trip, journey and travel correctly
- find key words before I match people to texts
- choose the option that answers the question
- use because, as and so to give reasons
- use irregular past verbs (went, saw, took)
- talk for 1–2 minutes from my notes

IELTS STRATEGIES

Test habits to build in this unit

READING · P. 49 BOX, TIP 5 P. 50

Find the **key words** for each person, then match. Some, but **not all**, information may match.

LISTENING · P. 50 BOX

You may hear **all** the key words, but only one option answers the question.

SPEAKING · TIP 11 P. 51, BOX P. 54

Give reasons with **as, so, because**. In Part 2, plan for one minute, then speak for **1–2 minutes**.

VOCABULARY · TIP 22 P. 54

Know the difference: a **trip**, a **journey** and the verb **travel**.

LEAD-IN

What kind of traveller are you?

Beach holiday
sun, sea, rest

City break
museums, buildings, shops

Adventure
climbing, cycling, camping

Language exchange
host family, classes

Choose one. Tell a partner why: “I’d choose a city break **because**…”

VOCABULARY

Holiday activities: go, visit, stay, try, see

go	go on	visit	stay with / see	try
horse riding	day trips	water parks	host families	traditional food
mountain climbing	cycling tours	beach resorts	local attractions	a new sport
shopping	cultural visits	a museum	famous buildings	local dishes

Sort them: which activities fit a city break, an adventure holiday, a beach holiday or a language exchange?

VOCABULARY

Trip, journey or travel?

a trip (noun)

a holiday or short visit

a school trip, a day trip

a journey (noun)

going from A to B

The journey took six hours.

travel (verb)

go to other places

I love to travel.

IELTS STRATEGY

Know the difference between a trip, a journey and the verb travel.

READING SKILL

Matching people to descriptions

1

Key words

Underline what each person wants: age, who with, likes.

2

Same idea

Find it in the texts in different words.

3

Check it all

Does the text match **every** need, or only some?

4

Cross out

There may be extra texts you don’t use.

IELTS STRATEGY

Identify the key words and ideas for each person, then match. Read carefully: some, but not all, of the information may match.

READING PRACTICE

Which holiday is best for Sara?

Sara, 17: “I want to see famous buildings with my school friends. We can’t afford an expensive hotel.”

A · Luxury Paris

Five-star hotel next to the Eiffel Tower. Adults only.

B · Rome on a budget

Cheap hostel rooms for groups of students. Daily tours of famous sights.

C · Alpine Adventure

Low-cost camping for young people. Climbing and hiking every day.

LISTENING · INTERVIEW TASK

Key words first, then listen

Why did Tom go to Japan?

A He wanted to see temples.

B His uncle lives there.

C He won a competition.

“The temples were amazing, and I visited my uncle in Kyoto. But I only went because I won a writing prize at school.”

Answer: C (prize = competition)

IELTS STRATEGY

Underline key words in the question and options.

You may hear **all** of them, but only **one** answers the question.

You may not hear the **exact** words.

SPEAKING · ADDING DETAIL AND REASONS

Because, as and so

Word	Comes before…	Example
because	the reason	We went to Spain because it’s warm.
as	the reason	As I love food, I tried everything.
so	the result	It rained, so we went to a museum.

IELTS STRATEGY

In the Speaking test, give more details and reasons. Use **as**, **so** and **because** to connect your ideas, and notice the order.

GRAMMAR · FORM AND USE

Past simple and present simple

	Present simple: habits, states	Past simple: finished actions
+	We usually go to the beach.	We went to the mountains.
–	I don’t like long journeys.	I didn’t like the journey.
?	Do you travel a lot?	Did you enjoy it?
be	It isn’t very hot.	It wasn’t very hot.

After didn’t and did, use the base verb: didn’t *go* (not didn’t went), Did you *see*…?

GRAMMAR · COMMON MISTAKES

Find the mistake

Wrong	Right	Why?
Last year I go to Rome.	Last year I went to Rome.	finished time
We didn’t visited the castle.	We didn’t visit the castle.	didn’t + base
She taked lots of photos.	She took lots of photos.	irregular
The hotel didn’t clean.	The hotel wasn’t clean.	be: wasn’t
I usually went with my family.	I usually go with my family.	habit

WRITING · EMAILS

An email about your last holiday

1
Greeting
Hi Hannah,

2
Where?
where, when, who with, how

3
What?
activities and a reason

4
Ask
about their last holiday

5
Closing
Write soon, + name

Check the task: answer only what the instructions ask, use the past simple for the holiday, and keep to the word count.

WRITING · MODEL

A model email (about 105 words)

Hi Hannah,

Thanks for your email! Last April, I **went** to Chiang Mai with my parents. We **travelled** by train and the journey **took** eleven hours. **Usually we go** to the beach, but this time we wanted something different. We **stayed** in a small hotel near the old city. On the first day, we **visited** temples and **tried** local food at the night market. I loved the mountains **because** it was cool and green. It rained one day, **so** we **did** a cooking class. My favourite moment was feeding the elephants at a sanctuary. Where **did you go** on your last holiday?

Write soon, Ploy

Past simple for the holiday · **present simple** for a habit · **because / so** for reasons and results · a question at the end

SPEAKING · EXPERIENCES (LIKE IELTS PART 2)

One minute to plan, two minutes to talk

Task card

Describe a place you visited with your family.

You should say: where it was · when you went · what you did there · and explain why you remember it.

IELTS STRATEGY

Use the one minute to plan. Write **notes**, not on the task card.

Follow every prompt. Speak for **1–2 minutes**.

No very short answers: add **examples and reasons**.

PAIR PRACTICE

Talk for two minutes

Plan · 1 min

Two or three words for each prompt on your card.

Speak · 1–2 min

Use your notes. Give reasons with because, as, so.

Listen

Tick: every prompt? past simple? a reason? Then swap.

REVIEW

Can you…?

- Name four types of holiday and their activities
- Use trip, journey and travel correctly
- Use the past simple and present simple
- Match people to texts using key words
- Choose the option that answers the question
- Talk for 1–2 minutes with reasons

Next: take the *Unit 4 Challenge* on Miss L Gems and submit your PDF on Google Classroom.